

the first release. The application is of great use, especially for travellers, in order to get region- or state-specific applications that include apps on local transportation, hotspots and food joints.

Google's 'Bouncer' to guard Android Market!

Google has officially announced its new security feature, 'Bouncer', for the Android Market.

This provides automated scanning of the Android Market for potentially malicious software without disrupting the user experience or requiring developers to go through an application approval process.

The Bouncer will act as a watchman to check potentially harmful malware uploads to the Android Market. Google's Bouncer automatically scans the Android Market, analysing both the new apps and those available in the Market—and it even checks developer accounts for harmful applications. Since the advent of this service, between the first and second halves of 2011, the Official Google Mobile Blog states that there was a 40 per cent decrease in the number of potentially-malicious downloads from Android Market.

Once an app is submitted to the Android Market, the Bouncer immediately starts analysing it for known malware, spyware and Trojans. It then compares it against previously analysed apps to detect possible red flags. In fact, Google runs every application on Google's cloud infrastructure and simulates how it will run on an Android device, to look for hidden, malicious behaviour.

World's first bamboo phone coming to the UK market

The world's first bamboo smartphone that runs the Android operating system will be launched in the UK. The smartphone, which is called Adzero, has been designed by a student—Kieron-Scott Woodhouse at Middlesex University—and is made from four-year old organic bamboo treated for durability. Originally, the handset was planned for the Chinese market, but when showcased at a show during the London Design Week, it garnered a lot of attention. The Adzero is a prototype, and runs the Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich operating system. All the specs of the phone are not available yet, but it will sport a bigger screen compared to Apple's iPhone 4S. Also, it will have a circular flash around the camera.



Xiaomi makes MIUI open source!

The China-based creator of MIUI Android ROM, Xiaomi, has announced plans to make the source code of MIUI open source. The company has provided the link <https://github.com/MiCode> displaying the apps that have already been made open source. Furthermore, the official post says that other applications and code are likely to be published in the very near future.

Presently, the announced source release is for Android 2.3.7 'Gingerbread'. This is exciting news for Android ROM developers who wish to port MIUI parts in their custom ROMs.

15 March: National conference on open source at Jamia Milia Islamia

A conference will be organised by the FTK Centre for Information Technology (FTK-CIT), Jamia Milia Islamia in New Delhi on the 'Emerging Trends in Open Source Applications and Cloud Computing (OSACC – 2012)' on March 15, 2012.

The national conference is in continuation of the earlier conferences held on the 'Sustainable Development and Management of Information Technology in Universities and Colleges' that were organised by the Centre in 2009 and 2010. OSACC-2012 will provide an opportunity to researchers, academicians, professionals from the industry, and students from Indian universities and colleges to discuss and debate these important issues under one roof. A lot of technical sessions and talks by ICT experts and practitioners will take place at the conference.

The main objectives of the conference will include Open Education Resources (OERs) and open source software, open source applications, cloud computing platforms, the implications of cloud computing, and open source applications in educational institutions.